Line 14:

'*Seeking the bubble reputation*': a bubble is empty, so by 'seeking the bubble reputation', Shakespeare means a short lived glory.

Line 15:

'*Even in the cannon's mouth*': a 'cannon' - large gun, and its 'mouth' was at the front -so the man seeks his reputation even if it means standing in front of guns.

Line 16:

'*capon lin'd*': 'to line' means to fill something at the edges here, the man was fat from eating good chicken.

Line 20:

'*lean and slipper'd pantaloon*' : this phrase describes a thin old man.

Line 23:

'*shrunk shank*': - 'to shrink' means to grow smaller, and a 'shank' is a piece of meat cut from a leg of an animal - so man's legs have grown narrower with age.

Line 24:

'*treble*': a treble is the higher part of a piece of music - so Shakespeare is referring to a boy's high-pitched voice.

Line 27:

'*oblivion*': if someone is 'oblivious' he/she doesn't know what is happening around him/her, and if he/she lives in 'oblivion' he/she is completely forgotten by other people.

1. Fill in the blanks using the words given in the box to complete the summary of the poem.

Shakespeare considers the whole world a stage where men and women are only (1) _____. They (2)_____the stage when they are born and exit when they die. Every man, during his life time, plays seven roles based on age. In the first act, as an infant, he is wholly (3) _____on the mother or a nurse. Later, emerging as a school child, he slings his bag over his shoulder and creeps most (4)_____ to school. His next act is that of a lover, busy (5) _____ballads for his beloved and yearns for her (6) _____. In the fourth stage, he is aggressive and ambitious and seeks (7) _____in all that he does. He (8) _____solemnly to guard his country and becomes a soldier. As he grows older, with (9) _____and wisdom, he becomes a fair judge. During this stage, he is firm and (10) _____. In the sixth act, he is seen with loose pantaloons and spectacles. His manly voice changes into a childish (11) _____. The last scene of all is his second childhood. Slowly, he loses his (12) _____of sight, hearing, smell and taste and exits from the roles of his life.

attention	treble	reluctantly
actors	maturity	reputation
serious	faculties	composing
enter	promises	dependent

2. From your understanding of the poem, answer the following questions briefly in a sentence or two.

a) What is the world compared to?

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